



NO. 6 OF 16

Frankie Dade

THE BANDLEADER

“The band plays on, whatever happens. Even in the dark.”

FOR FRANKIE DADE’S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A pinstripe suit, two-tone shoes, a skinny tie and a conductor’s baton.

DRESS STYLE

A dark velvet dress, a pinstripe jacket over the shoulders and a conductor’s baton.

MASK: Plain black (the band)

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You lead the eight-piece Blue Lantern Orchestra. From the bandstand you can see the whole ballroom and the balcony above it. The service corridor, with the fuse box, runs right behind the bandstand.

YOUR SECRET

Two years ago Gus lent you \$2,000 to replace the band's instruments after a fire. You still owe most of it, and last week Gus wrote that he wanted every cent back by Christmas or he would keep the instruments. You also know the club's wiring: you fixed the stage lights last spring.

You are innocent

You conducted the band on the bandstand from 11:30 until the lights went out, in front of the whole room.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING FRANKIE

Your manner: Easygoing, musical and full of stories. Tap rhythms on the tables and use plenty of jazz slang ("swell", "the bee's knees", "the cat's pyjamas").

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Be the calm one: “Lights go out, the band plays on. That’s the rule.” Share what you saw from the bandstand: from 11:50 Jordan Pierce and Morgan Bellamy were up on the balcony, deep in conversation, and they were still there when the lights went out.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Admit the debt if asked. Share what you heard: a few seconds after the lights went out, the service corridor door right behind you banged shut. Somebody had been in that corridor.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit you know the wiring. But point out that a fuse unscrewed by hand needs no skill at all. Ask: who walked past the bandstand toward the corridor just before midnight?

Notes & suspects



YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
Morgan Bellamy	Owner of The Gilded Owl	Gus's business rival
Frankie Dade	The Bandleader	Owes Gus a large sum of money
Charlie Ashby	The Society Columnist	Wore the silver fox mask; had a column about Gus
Dana Rook	The Caterer	In charge of the champagne tower
Leslie Croft	Gus's Lawyer	Knows exactly what the new will says
Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club